

	EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES AGENCY	POLICY NUMBER	712
	A Division of the Merced County Department of Public Health	Effective Date	11/2025
Authority: Health and Safety Code, Division 2.5, and California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 9, Chapter 4, 1797.220		Initial Date:	07/2022
		Review Date:	01/2028

AIRWAY OBSTRUCTION	
ADULT	PEDIATRIC
BLS	
Assess Vitals / Obtain SpO ₂ / Oxygen - Titrate to SpO ₂ of 94% or higher / Secure Airway - Assist Ventilations if needed. CPR - If the patient is unresponsive perform chest compressions checking the patient's mouth regularly for obstruction. DO NOT PERFORM a blind finger sweep.	
Abdominal Thrusts - If the patient is awake and has complete obstruction perform abdominal thrusts, until the object dislodges, or the patient becomes unresponsive.	Patient < 1 year of age - Back Blows and Chest Thrusts - Perform four (4) back blows followed by four (4) chest thrusts until the airway clears Patient > 1 year of age - Abdominal Thrusts - If the patient is awake and has complete obstruction perform abdominal thrusts, until the object dislodges, or the patient becomes unresponsive
ALS	
Follow BLS procedures if applicable. Obtain 4-Lead ECG – If indicated. Vascular Access – If indicated. Severe / Complete Airway Obstruction: Magill Forceps - If unresponsive, perform direct laryngoscopy and remove obstruction with Magill Forceps if applicable. Once obstruction is removed use appropriate airway as needed. Needle Cricothyrotomy – Perform if unable to ventilate patient by any other means - Consider Air Transport, or transport patient to the closest Emergency Department	

Signatures on File

Approved By: Tim Williams
EMS Administrator

Ajinder Singh, MD
EMS Medical Director